

Manual 25 — ISO 22301 Business Continuity Management Controlled Implementation

01. Purpose, scope, and controlled-use boundary

Establish a practical BCMS implementation model without reproducing ISO normative text or implying certification, legal compliance, or audit opinion.

02. Source hierarchy and version control

Maintain a source register separating ISO 22301:2019, Amendment 1:2024, ISO 22313 guidance, internal policy, contractual requirements, regulatory overlays, and change-watch material.

03. Organizational context

Identify internal and external issues affecting continuity capability, including dependencies, operating environment, stakeholders, climate-related context where relevant, and strategic constraints.

04. Interested parties and obligations

Maintain a controlled inventory of customer, regulatory, contractual, workforce, supplier, and public-sector continuity expectations with owners and evidence.

05. BCMS scope and boundaries

Define organizational units, services, sites, technologies, suppliers, data, facilities, and exclusions within the BCMS boundary.

06. Leadership and accountability

Assign executive sponsorship, policy ownership, decision rights, escalation authority, funding responsibility, and evidence accountability.

07. Business continuity policy

Maintain an approved policy aligned to organizational objectives, scope, obligations, resilience expectations, and continual-improvement commitments.

08. Roles, responsibilities, and competence

Define accountable roles for business continuity, crisis leadership, service owners, technology recovery, facilities, communications, legal, HR, procurement, and assurance.

09. Planning for risks and opportunities

Identify BCMS-level risks and opportunities that could affect the management system's intended outcomes and define tracked treatments.

10. Business impact analysis governance

Establish BIA methodology, review cadence, data quality controls, approval authority, and linkage to service inventories and recovery strategies.

11. Critical products and services

Identify priority products, services, activities, and value streams, including acceptable outage tolerances and stakeholder impacts.

12. Impact criteria and time dimensions

Define financial, legal, safety, customer, operational, regulatory, reputational, and mission impact criteria across time-based disruption intervals.

13. Dependencies and resource requirements

Map people, facilities, technology, data, utilities, suppliers, logistics, communications, and specialist dependencies needed for prioritized activities.

14. Risk assessment for disruption

Assess disruption scenarios, vulnerabilities, single points of failure, concentration risk, geographic exposure, cyber/physical dependencies, and cascading effects.

15. Continuity strategy selection

Select proportionate strategies based on BIA and risk results, balancing resilience, recovery capability, cost, complexity, and residual risk.

16. People and workforce continuity

Define staffing alternatives, succession, cross-training, remote-work capability, welfare, travel, access, safety, and workforce communication controls.

17. Facilities and physical resilience

Address alternate workspace, utilities, environmental controls, physical security, site access, geographic diversification, and facility recovery dependencies.

18. Technology and cyber recovery integration

Integrate BCMS objectives with disaster recovery, backup, restoration, cyber incident response, identity recovery, infrastructure resilience, and application dependencies.

19. Information and data continuity

Protect availability, integrity, recoverability, retention, confidentiality, and controlled access to information required during disruption and recovery.

20. Third-party and supply-chain continuity

Define supplier continuity requirements, due diligence, evidence, concentration-risk review, alternate sourcing, escalation, contract clauses, and reassessment.

21. Crisis management structure

Define strategic, tactical, and operational crisis roles, activation criteria, command structure, decision logging, handoffs, and executive escalation.

22. Incident and continuity response procedures

Maintain usable procedures for activation, stabilization, continuity, recovery, escalation, resource coordination, and stand-down.

23. Communications and stakeholder management

Define internal and external communications, spokesperson authority, message approval, regulator/customer notifications, contact maintenance, and rumor control.

24. Recovery objectives and restoration priorities

Translate approved business tolerances into operational recovery objectives, sequencing, minimum resource needs, and validated service restoration priorities.

25. Plan documentation and accessibility

Ensure plans are current, controlled, available under degraded conditions, appropriately protected, versioned, and understandable to intended users.

26. Training and awareness

Implement role-based awareness, competence development, onboarding, refresher training, crisis-leadership preparation, and evidence of completion.

27. Exercise and testing program

Maintain a risk-based exercise program using walkthroughs, simulations, technical recovery tests, supplier exercises, crisis exercises, and integrated scenarios.

28. Exercise findings and remediation

Record observations, root causes, action owners, due dates, residual risk, retest requirements, and closure evidence for exercise and incident findings.

29. Monitoring, measurement, and metrics

Define BCMS indicators for readiness, plan currency, recovery performance, exercise effectiveness, supplier resilience, issue aging, and objective achievement.

30. Internal audit and assurance

Plan independent, evidence-based assurance over BCMS design and operation, preserving auditor competence, scope, sampling, findings, and follow-up boundaries.

31. Management review and continual improvement

Provide leadership with evidence on performance, changes, incidents, exercises, audit results, risks, resources, objectives, and improvement actions.

32. Release, evidence, and implementation roadmap

Package an Essential / Structured / Enhanced implementation roadmap with source verification, control/evidence mapping, issue tracking, localization, accessibility, provenance, checksum, workflow-security, and release gates. Recheck ISO source status immediately before publication and treat ISO/CD 22301 as non-normative change-watch unless and until formally published.